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Homo agit. Man acts.

That is the sentence from which every claim in these pages descends. It is not a rhetorical flourish; it is the axiomatic foundation of an entire tradition. Ludwig von Mises took it, in *Die Gemeinwirtschaft* (1922) and *Human Action* (1949), to be *a priori* — a proposition the denial of which is itself an instance of what it denies. To argue against the axiom that man acts is to act.

From this seed the Austrian tradition has grown an economics of unusual rigour and unusual beauty: the subjectivist theory of value, the pure time-preference theory of interest, the theory of economic calculation, the knowledge problem, spontaneous order, the regression theorem of money, the theory of roundabout production, the theory of the business cycle. These are not — pace their reputation — dry results. They are among the most elegant ideas in the social sciences. You would not know it from how they are taught.

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Why this exists

Open any standard textbook. Open any PDF from a monetary-policy conference. Open most of the internet's existing attempts to explain "why Austrian economics matters." You will find, almost without exception, three failures repeated:

> *Economics deals with the real actions of real men.*

First, **failures of form** — dry prose on grey paper, often with layout that would embarrass a mid-century government pamphlet. Second, **failures of rigor** — strawmanned opponents, hand-waved theorems, footnotes that do not lead anywhere a reader can actually read. Third, **failures of voice** — the register of a grievance blog where the register of a scholarly journal is what the material deserves.

Praxeos is a small protest against all three. The ideas here will not be taught as if they were medicine. They will be taught the way they deserve: with primary sources cited, with generative interactives worth sharing as art in their own right, with the kind of craft that makes a reader want to tell a friend.

The medium is the message. A site that exists, looks exceptional, and teaches these ideas clearly is itself a demonstration of spontaneous order and purposeful action.

What a module is

Each module is a small monument. Six files on disk, one URL in the world:

A **generative or interactive piece** — a Haeckel-style botanical manuscript of Bitcoin's history; a woodcut forest whose shape reads Austrian capital theory; a typographic particle system that renders Mises's 1920 calculation argument. Each is designed to be screenshot-worthy on its own, independent of its essay.

An **essay of 500 to 1,200 words**, written in the voice of someone who has actually read *Human Action* and *Prices and Production*. Every non-trivial claim traces to a primary source. No strawmen. No hedging.

A **structured list of primary sources**, preferentially linking to archive.org and mises.org so the URLs outlive publisher churn.

A **permanent, linkable, shareable, archivable URL**. Modules are not deprecated. They are not behind paywalls. They do not die.

The lineage

Praxeos is a child of a lineage I take seriously. Bret Victor's *Kill Math* and *Up and Down the Ladder of Abstraction* showed that interactive explanations could carry arguments that prose could not. Nicky Case's *Evolution of Trust* and *Parable of the Polygons* showed that they could be warm, human, and politically mature. Bartosz Ciechanowski's mechanical essays showed what the top of the craft

looks like when one person cares enough. The Pudding showed that long-form data stories could hold an audience. Stripe Press' microsites showed what editorial design looks like when a software company decides to make a book.

None of these references are accidental. A site that hopes to teach Austrian economics seriously cannot merely gesture at those traditions; it must attempt to *join* them. Praxeos is an attempt.

The tradition

The Austrian school begins with Carl Menger (*Principles of Economics*, 1871), who located value in subjective individual valuation rather than objective labour cost. It is developed by Eugen von Böhm-Bawerk, whose *Capital and Interest* (1884–1912) grounded interest in time preference rather than exploitation; by Ludwig von Mises, whose 1920 essay *Die Wirtschaftsrechnung im sozialistischen Gemeinwesen* demonstrated that socialism cannot compute without market prices for the means of production; by F. A. Hayek, whose 1945 *Use of Knowledge in Society* reframed the economic problem as the coordination of dispersed knowledge through prices; by Murray Rothbard, whose *Man, Economy, and State* (1962) systematised the whole; by Israel Kirzner, who recovered entrepreneurship as perceptual alertness rather than technological invention; by Ludwig Lachmann, who emphasised the heterogeneity of capital and the subjectivity of expectations; by Joseph Salerno, whose reconstructive scholarship reclaimed Mises from the Langean distortions that dominated twentieth-century textbooks; by Saifedean Ammous, who placed Bitcoin within the same monetary tradition.

This is not a fringe lineage. It is a tradition that has produced Nobel laureates, policy revolutions, and — in 1920 — one of the most important and widely confirmed predictions in the history of the social sciences. Its current reputation is an accident of mid-century academic fashion, not a verdict on its arguments.

> ON POLITICS
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> *Praxeos is written in the Austrian tradition. It therefore carries its conclusions. Readers with other priors are welcome; the interactives do not preach. But the essays do not hedge. They argue.*

What this is not

It is not a textbook. Textbooks are exhaustive; Praxeos is selective. Each module picks one concept, renders it well, and leaves.

It is not a neutral pedagogy. An honest treatment of Austrian economics cannot pretend to be above the tradition; it must inhabit it. The interactives are pedagogically austere — a reader who only plays with them is never preached

at. The essays, by contrast, are written in the voice of someone who thinks the tradition is correct.

It is not a political tract. Politics is downstream of economics in this tradition; Praxeos focuses upstream. Where politics enters — in discussions of central-bank intervention, of socialist calculation, of regime uncertainty — it enters because the economics requires it.

It is not monetisable. The whole corpus is open source and Creative Commons. Modules can be translated, quoted, remixed, classroom-used. The code is MIT. The only thing required is attribution.

It is not a solo performance. The contributions policy opens after the launch of Fascicle I, through a proposal-first process with an editorial board of readers I trust in the tradition.

Fascicle I

Three modules ship together, coordinated like movements in a suite.

The Halving Garden — Every Bitcoin block from genesis to tip rendered as a Haeckel-style botanical organism on a Hilbert curve, arranged into four illuminated halving-epoch pages. New blocks arrive live. A quiet argument about sound money, emergent monetary order, and fixed supply under rules rather than discretion.

The Time Preference Forest — Austrian capital theory as an eighteenth-century woodcut. A generative forest whose morphology reads the reader's chosen time preference and a central-bank intervention slider. A "market correction" reveals actual capital depth through an eight-second cascading collapse.

The Calculation Problem — Mises's 1920 argument rendered as a two-panel typographic particle system. The left panel, with prices, self-organises into visible supply chains. The right panel, without prices, descends through shortages and surpluses into visible chaos. The reader may, if they wish, try to be the planner. They will fail; that is the pedagogical point.

More fascicles are drafted. The backlog — Cantillon Effect, Subjective Value, Regression Theorem, Spontaneous Order, Knowledge Problem, Roundaboutness, Hayekian Triangles, Say's Law — lives in `/docs/MODULE_IDEAS.md`.

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A note on the author

Praxeos is written and built by William Menjivar. It is a portfolio flagship, yes; a calling card; a contribution to the open web. It is also, more importantly, a book of love letters to ideas the author thinks are beautiful and deserve the treatment they receive here.

If you are a serious reader of this tradition and you find something imprecise, write. If you have read *Human Action* cover to cover and have a scholarly eye, write. If you are a designer or programmer who has seen the lineage of explorable explanations and want to help raise the ceiling, write.

The address is at the foot of every page.

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Homo agit.